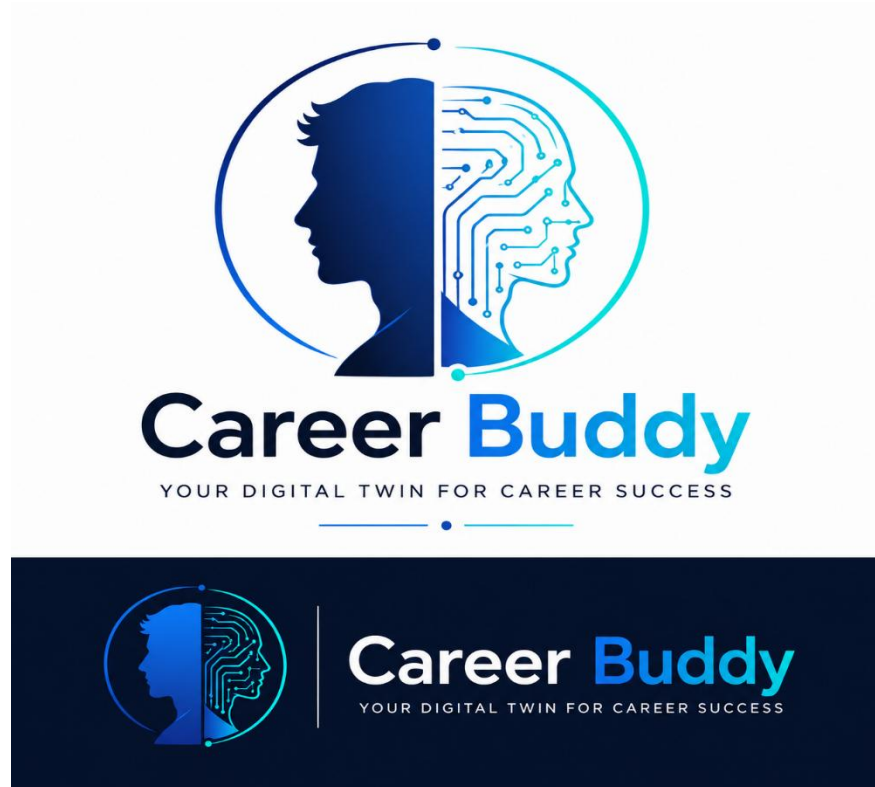


CareerBuddy: AI-Driven Career Transformation

Finalist Project – Dean’s Open Innovation Challenge 2026



An innovative solution addressing the "Future of Work" under the Data Visionaries theme at NOVA IMS (Information Management School).

Executive Summary

In an era where we are facing the uncertainty caused by the impact of AI in the workforce, where people feel lost and unable to accompany the constant changes in the economy and the labor market, and when employees start to question the meaning of their professions, *CareerBuddy* was developed to bridge the gap between current skills and future market demands. Our team designed a "**Digital Career Twin**"—a proactive ecosystem that integrates fragmented user data with real-time market intelligence to automate personalized career pathfinding. The project was recognized as a finalist among all competing teams for its innovative use of data and potential for societal impact.

Strategic Objectives

- **Predictive Upskilling:** Utilizing job APIs, employer intent signals, searching information about patents, scientific work, innovations and products released by companies, to forecast skills in demand before they became in high-demand, giving advantage for the ones who started to master them, before that stage.

- **Data Integration:** Consolidating explicit (resumes, certificates), implicit (personality, passions), and external (economic graphs, market analysis) data points into a unified user profile.
- **Scalable Impact:** Designing a dual B2C and B2B (Institutional/HR) business model to support lifelong human development.

Technical Implementation

As a core team member, I focused on the idea of the twin (online persona), the interface development, and the forecast engine.

My primary contribution involved:

- **Defining the type of interaction between user-AI:** instead of a cold and distant interaction between the user and the AI, I imagined the idea of a digital twin, an online version of the user, to work as a partner, allowing a more personalized experience.
- **Interface Engineering:** Developed a functional prototype that translates complex predictive data into a clear, actionable dashboard.

View Live Interface: [Career Buddy - Your Digital Twin for Career Success](#)

- **UX/UI Design:** Created an intuitive experience for three primary user personas: students navigating entry-level fatigue, professionals managing AI disruption, and specialists seeking career pivots.
- **Feature Logic:** Developed the components of the forecast engine, the visualization for the "Skill-based Graph" and the "Active Peer Matching" interface to facilitate social learning pathways.

Key Achievements

- **Finalist Standing:** Selected as a finalist to the pitch phase.
- **Presentation:** Pitched the solution at the **Pitch Day**, to a jury comprising the NOVA IMS Director, professors and industry leaders.